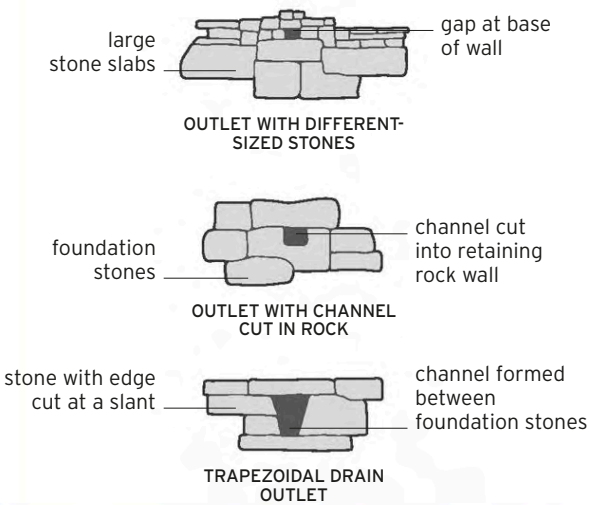


DRAINAGE ENGINEERING

Building Machu Picchu on steep slopes in an area of high rainfall demanded an astonishing level of engineering skill. The settlement had an advanced drainage system, with channels of varying profiles left in its retaining walls to allow water to escape during heavy storms and underground layers of stone chips that could act as temporary reservoirs for water. Without these features, the complex would have collapsed many years ago.



◁ THE TORRÉN
Located in the Temple of the Sun, the semicircular Torrén with its astronomically oriented trapezoidal windows was accessed through the “Serpent’s Gate” in the straight wall.

The **citadel** of Machu Picchu is **7,970 ft (2,430 m)** above sea level

